

1 Casual Catch-up – July 15, 2026

2 Attendees: Bala, Neeraj

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4 Bala: Hey, you got a minute? I just wanted to catch up quickly before the week gets crazy.

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6 Neeraj: Yeah of course, what's up?

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8 Bala: So I was chatting with the Thornfield guys yesterday. They're getting a bit antsy about the dedicated IP thing, but I managed to calm them down. Told them we're looking into it. I think they just need to feel like someone's paying attention, you know?

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10 Neeraj: Yeah I totally get that. Honestly I've been meaning to sit down and actually figure out what's involved. Like I have a rough idea but I haven't put anything on paper yet.

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12 Bala: Exactly, that's all I need from you honestly. Just a rough sense of the effort, the dependencies, whether it's a two day thing or a two week thing. Even a few bullet points would do. Can you get me something by end of next Thursday? Nothing fancy.

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14 Neeraj: Yeah Thursday works, I'll put something together.

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16 Bala: Perfect. And while I have you, how's the migration plan coming? Last I heard you were still drafting it.

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18 Neeraj: It's getting there. I keep getting pulled into other stuff though. The payments service migration is the gnarly one because we can't afford any downtime. I want to make sure I've actually thought through the rollback scenario properly before I share it with anyone.

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20 Bala: That's fair, don't rush it if it's not ready. But at some point we need to get it in front of the wider team so they can plan around it. Even a draft would help.

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22 Neeraj: Yeah you're right. Okay, I'll send you a draft by end of month. Like it might still have some gaps but at least people can start looking at it.

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24 Bala: That's all I ask. Hey, did you ever sort out the AWS billing thing? I got another unexpected charge notification this morning and I nearly choked on my coffee.

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26 Neeraj: Oh man, no I haven't. I keep pushing it. It's one of those things that's not urgent until it is, you know?

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28 Bala: Yeah but it kind of is now, right? I mean it's not the end of the world but it's also not a great look when finance asks questions and we can't explain the spike. Actually you know what, before you even set up the alerts, it would help if I got finance to send over the billing breakdown from last month. Then at least we know what we're actually dealing with. I'll chase them today.

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30 Neeraj: That would actually be really useful, yeah.

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32 Neeraj: Fair point. I'll set up the cost alerts this week. Like proper threshold alerts, not just the default ones AWS gives you.

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34 Bala: This week meaning before Friday?

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36 Neeraj: Yeah before Friday, July 18th. I'll do it.

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38 Bala: Appreciate it. Oh and completely different topic, have you looked at the security audit report yet? The full one, not just the summary.

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40 Neeraj: I skimmed it. The token rotation thing stood out to me, that one's embarrassing honestly. We should have had that from the start.

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42 Bala: Right? The auditors were pretty pointed about it. I don't want to be dramatic but if that came up in a client security review it would not be a good conversation.

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44 Neeraj: No, totally agree. I'll make it a priority. I'm thinking I can have something implemented and written up, like a proper policy doc, by the end of the first week of August.

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46 Bala: August 1st?

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48 Neeraj: Yeah August 1st works.

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50 Bala: Okay good. And you know what, while you're in that headspace, the error messages thing from the audit is also on you right? The verbose stack traces?

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52 Neeraj: Oh yeah, I actually think that one's quick. It's just a matter of going through the error handlers and making sure we're not leaking internals. I can probably knock that out in a day or two. Let's say July 29th, gives me a buffer.

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54 Bala: Yeah that works. Alright I think that's everything I had. How are you doing generally? You seem a bit stretched.

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56 Neeraj: Honestly yeah, a bit. But it's fine. These things go in waves.

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58 Bala: Fair enough. Let me know if you need anything offloaded. Actually, speaking of which, I keep forgetting to loop Thornfield in with a holding message, just something to acknowledge we haven't forgotten them while your scoping is in progress. I should probably send that this week, like by Wednesday, otherwise they'll follow up again and it'll be the same conversation.

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60 Neeraj: Yeah they seem like the type to follow up.

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62 Bala: Exactly. Okay I'll send that by Wednesday July 17th. Alright, I'll let you get back to it.

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64 Neeraj: Cheers, appreciate it.

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66 Bala: Oh wait, one more thing. The retrospective. You were supposed to get that in the calendar.

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68 Neeraj: Oh right yeah. I'll do that today actually. I'll send the invite out before EOD.

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70 | Bala: Before EOD today, July 15th?

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72 | Neeraj: Yes, I promise.

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74 | Bala: Okay I'm holding you to that. Alright, talk later.

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76 | Neeraj: See you.

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